

Philosophy Tripos, Part II

Wednesday, 04 June 2025

09:00 to 12:00

Paper 1

METAPHYSICS

Answer **three** questions only.

Write the number of the question at the beginning of each answer.

Write your candidate number (**NOT** your name) on the cover sheet of **each** answer booklet (or on the top of **each** submitted document, if submitting word-processed documents).

STATIONERY REQUIREMENTS

20 Page Answer Book (if sitting exam in exam hall)

You may not start to read the questions printed on the subsequent pages of this question paper until instructed to do so.

1. What is it to be realist about a sphere of discourse?
2. 'If semantic externalism is true, I can know *a priori* that there is water in my environment. That is absurd. Therefore semantic externalism is false.'
Discuss.
3. Which categories of entity are required to explain the existence and nature of facts?
4. Is the abstract-concrete distinction a matter of degree?
5. Is there a significant distinction between a triggering cause and a causal condition?
6. Is backwards causation possible?
7. Is the growing block theory of time defensible?
8. Is the notion of a temporal part coherent?
9. Is every person constituted by an animal?
10. If the self is a fiction, is it a story worth telling?

END OF PAPER